

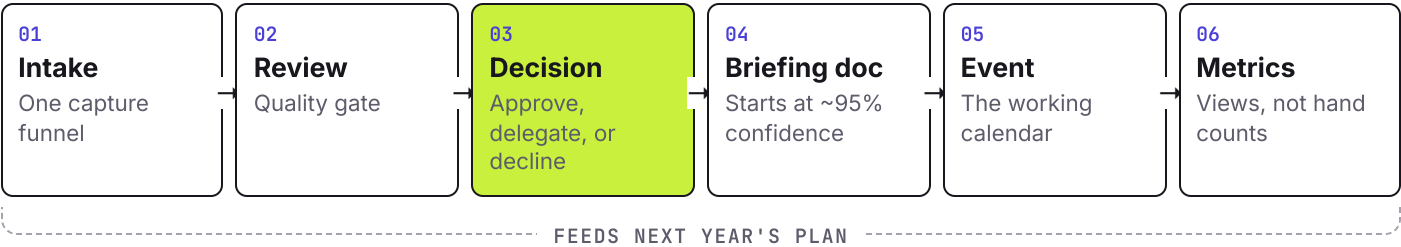
Executive Engagement Program Playbook

How a central team runs executive meetings and side events at Northwind's flagship annual forum, from first invite to leadership debrief. Written so the team can run it without the author.

THE ONE RULE

Every engagement is one row. A 1:1 meeting and a hosted dinner live in the same table. Side events are a filtered view, not a second system. That is why one calendar can show a delegate's whole week, and why nothing has to sync between trackers.

Six stages in a loop



HOW TO READ IT

Each stage lists four facts: what triggers it, who owns it, where it lives, and what done looks like.

The stage structure is the reusable part. The forum details are the fill-in. To run a different program, keep the stages and swap the specifics.

THE PROGRAM	6 executive delegates, CEO first	~240 invites a season, peaking six weeks out	1 event week, in a host city	1 tracker (Airtable), team-owned
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COMPANION DOC

The build plan covers the data model and source-of-truth decisions. This playbook is how the program runs. The plan is how the tracker is built.

WHY IT EXISTS

Invites reach the program through many people, and the season peaks fast. The playbook puts intake, decisions, briefing docs, and reporting in one system the team owns. The program survives a handoff, and the debrief comes straight from the tracker.

Roles

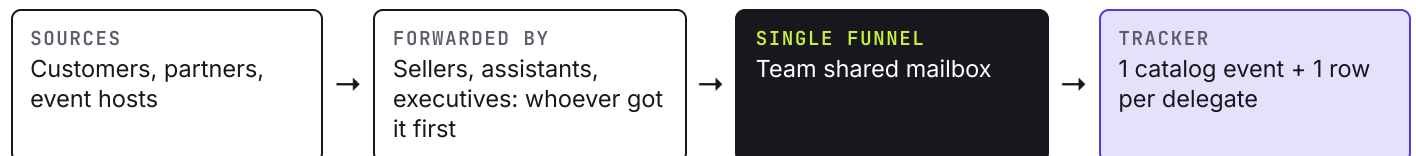
ROLE	OWNS
Program owner	The system, the plan, and the handoff. Not the day-to-day during season.
Program operator	Intake, decisions, and tracking during season. This playbook is written for this person to run alone.
Engagement managers	One per delegate. Attendance decisions and the delegate's schedule.
Briefing writers	Side-event briefing docs. New this cycle, to take load off the core team.
Data support	CRM pulls: account owner, regional sales leaders, spend.
Coordination team	Advises delegate teams on fit and conflicts. Sends RSVPs. Owns the tracker.

Handoff test: nothing can depend on one person's laptop or login. Invites go to a team-owned shared mailbox. The tracker is a team-owned base. The automation (page 5) has to pass the same test.

01 Intake

ONE CAPTURE FUNNEL

TRIGGER	OWNER	WHERE	DONE
An invite arrives. Volume peaks about six weeks before the event.	Coordination team.	Shared mailbox, then one catalog event and one engagement row per delegate.	Every invite is logged, accepted or not. Declines count in the reporting.



Most invites arrive forwarded. Hosts don't know the central team by name, so invites land with sellers and executives first. The shared mailbox is the one place they all converge, which makes it the funnel.

Log first, decide later. Log the event before anyone decides on it. One invite for three delegates becomes one catalog event and three linked engagement rows.

02 Review

QUALITY GATE

TRIGGER

A new invite is logged.

OWNER

Coordination team.

WHERE

The "Needs review" view on the engagements table.

DONE

Fields complete and routed to the right delegate team, or flagged and settled by a person.

Confirm six fields: event name, date and time, host, category, RSVP deadline, and which delegates it concerns. Automated intake fills most of them. Review catches what the automation flagged as unclear.

03 Decision

APPROVE, DELEGATE, OR DECLINE

TRIGGER

A reviewed invite needs a yes or no.

OWNER

The delegate team, together. CEO first. If not the CEO, a named delegate.

WHERE

The same row. A decision is a status change plus the Exec field.

DONE

Status shows the decision. Exec shows who owns it.

DECISION

SET STATUS

SET EXEC

THEN

Approve

In progress →
Confirmed, hold sent

CEO

Briefing doc starts at ~95%

Delegate

Waiting room → Confirmed

Named delegate

Same briefing path

Decline

Declined: meeting
Declined: event

None

Row stays. The invite still counts.

Hold

TBC No response Not scheduled

None

Stays in queue. Reviewed weekly.

No separate approval step. Approval objects drift out of sync with the tracker. A status change on the row the team already works in does not.

The cascade: the CEO's and president's calendars firm up first. Their declines open slots that pass to other delegates. "Waiting room" is that handoff step, so the status itself tells the team a slot is moving. The coordination team sends the RSVP after the delegate team decides.

04 Briefing doc

STARTS AT ~95% CONFIDENCE

TRIGGER

Attendance is confirmed or about 95% likely.

OWNER

Briefing writers, with core-team review.

WHERE

Briefing status and doc link, on the engagement row.

DONE

Status is Complete and the link is attached.

The 95% bar stops docs for events that fall through. Writing too early wastes the team's hours. Writing too late leaves the executive walking in cold.

Side events use a standard template, with attendee bios for small dinners. Briefing status rolls up to each delegate, so during prep the team can see which meetings still need a doc.

05 Event

THE WORKING CALENDAR

TRIGGER

Event week.

OWNER

Delegates and the coordination team, onsite.

WHERE

The daily onsite calendar and per-delegate calendars.

DONE

Marked attended. Onsite feedback captured.

Event week changes by the hour: late slots, backup meetings kept warm, declines that reshuffle a day. The calendars are where the team works. Status moves to Completed. Onsite feedback and final attendees go on the row for the debrief.

Four calendar views, one table

The team asked to keep calendars. Because every engagement is one row, each view is a filter.

All-up

Every engagement, colored by type.

Per delegate

A delegate's whole week: meetings and side events together.

Side events only

Filtered to type = side event.

Daily onsite

What is happening today, for the team on the ground.

Before you build them: a calendar needs a real start date-time field. If start time is stored as text, convert it first.

06 Metrics and debrief

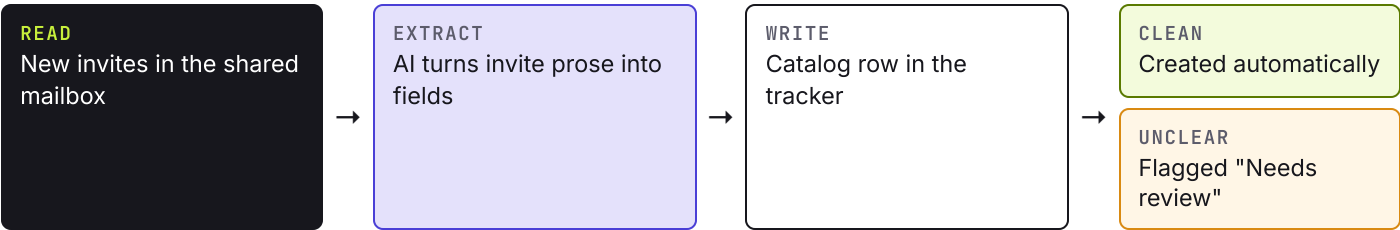
VIEWS, NOT HAND COUNTS

TRIGGER	OWNER	WHERE	DONE
After the event, and live during prep.	Program owner and coordination team.	Grouped and rollup views, then the leadership debrief.	Every debrief number comes from the tracker.
CATEGORY	WHAT LEADERSHIP ASKS FOR	EXAMPLE READOUT	
Volume	1:1 meetings, 1:1 vs joint, per delegate; side events, speaking slots, hosted events	96 meetings • 34 side events • 11 talks • 2 hosted	
Mix	Customer vs government; inbound vs outbound; venue	71% customer • 58% inbound	
Reach	Unique external leaders and organizations, by region	132 leaders • 88 orgs	
Quality	Briefing doc completion; follow-ups booked (briefing center visits, workshops)	100% briefed • 27 follow-ups	
Headline	Invites per delegate; side events actually attended	Every row, year over year	

Every metric is a view. Group the engagements table by exec, origin, status, or venue and the number appears. The two headline figures are rollups on the delegates table. Keep last year's numbers: the year-over-year comparison is what makes the debrief.

+ The automation layer

INTAKE AT PEAK VOLUME



Where it runs matters because of the handoff. The team has to own it.

OPTION	HOW IT READS THE MAILBOX	TEAM-OWNED?	EFFORT
A. Agent on one person's account	Reads only that person's mailbox. Can't reach the shared one.	No	Ruled out
B. Email-to-table + tracker automations	Native email intake, or a connector into the tracker	Yes	Low to medium
C. Cloud function + mail API + LLM	A service account reads the shared mailbox	Yes, always on	High

Recommendation: start with B. It uses tools the team already has. Move to C only if B can't parse messy peak-season invites. Prove the extraction logic first, because it is the same wherever it runs.

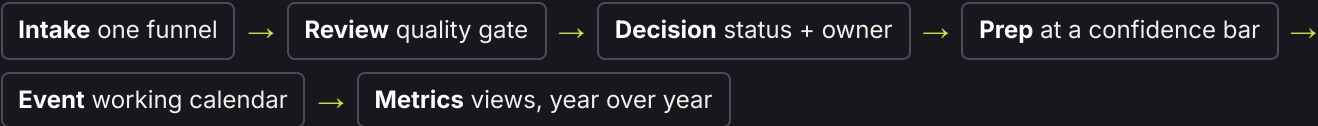
Other automations, all native and visible to the team: receipt acknowledgment • "approved but no calendar hold" alert • briefing doc trigger at 95% • weekly digest per delegate • post-event follow-up request.

Annual reset

Structure and roster roll forward. Last year's rows do not. The old base is what you report from.

- 01 Re-anchor the workback plan to next year's event dates.
- 02 Roll the delegate roster forward. Archive last year's engagements.
- 03 Clone the task workback.
- 04 Keep last year's metrics for the year-over-year debrief.
- 05 Point the intake automation at the new season's mailbox flow.

THE REPEATABLE SKELETON



Take out the forum and this runs any executive engagement program: an advisory board, a briefing center, a conference presence. Define four things: the funnel, the decision statuses, the prep trigger, and the five numbers leadership wants. The patterns carry over as they are: one engagement object, views for separation, rollups for metrics, calendars for the working surface.

Open decisions at handoff

#	DECISION	OWNER	NOTE
1	Automation host: option B or C	Program owner	Leaning B
2	Add a start date-time field to the engagements table	Operator	Blocks the calendars
3	Forwarding rule for invites sent to the operator directly	Operator	Not all are copied to the mailbox
4	Spend-data accuracy check on CRM pulls	Data support	With the CRM data team
5	Map last year's side-event tracker fields to the catalog	Operator	RSVP deadline, transferable, host, attendees
6	Formalize the briefing doc process with the writers	Program owner	Working session booked

How this playbook was built

CHOICE	THE RULE BEHIND IT
Written for the operator	A playbook only the author can run is a diary. Every stage names an owner who isn't the author.
Four facts per stage	Trigger, owner, where, done. If a stage can't fill all four, it isn't a stage yet.
One object, many views	Separate systems need syncing. Views of one table don't.
Decline rows stay	The debrief counts what the program turned down as well as what it took.
Open items in the doc	A handoff with hidden gaps fails in week one. Name them, with owners.